

Start Here



**KINGB**  
KITS

# Agave Night

Sip it, don't shoot it

## PRE-PARTY PLANNING

- **Three one-ounce pours per guest** - that's the whole night. A 750ml bottle holds about 25 tastes, so one bottle per spirit covers six to eight people comfortably.
- Pick **one tier** from the Agavebase and stay in it. Pouring a \$25 blanco against a \$120 wild-agave mezcal just makes the cheap one taste broken.
- Buying or BYO both work - three bottles total is the whole shopping list.

## SET A DATE AND SEND INVITES

- Say the word "tasting" in the invite. It sets expectations away from shots and toward a seated hour.
- Tell everyone to eat beforehand. This is high proof on a slow schedule.

## GATHER SUPPLIES

- Copitas, veladoras, or small wine glasses - anything that holds aroma. Never shot glasses.
- Water and plain crackers between pours.
- Orange slices, and chili salt or sal de gusano if you can find it.

## PARTY SETUP

- Three glasses per guest if you have them, so pours can sit side by side and be revisited.
- Bag or hide the bottles for a blind round - labels change what people think they taste.
- Pour one ounce, no more. Everyone gets a tasting card before the first pour.

## DURING THE PARTY

- **No ice, no lime, no salt.** That ritual exists to cover cheap mixto. Good agave doesn't need hiding.
- Nose it with your mouth slightly open. A hard sniff at 40%+ ABV just numbs you.
- Small sip, let it coat, then swallow. The second sip always reads differently than the first - that one is the honest one.
- Five to ten minutes and a sip of water between pours. Close with a vote.

## SNACK PAIRINGS

Orange slices with chili salt, dark chocolate, salted nuts, aged cheese, grilled pineapple. Skip anything sugary or lime-forward - both flatten the agave.

## WHAT'S IN THIS KIT

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**Invitation**

Editable Canva template

## Set up your RSVP before you send the invite:

1. [Click to copy the RSVP form](#) - your own private copy, replies land in your account, not ours.
2. Click Send in your new form and copy the link, then open the Invitation above, click the QR code, hit Edit, paste your link, and click Update code.

# Know Your Agave

Enough to order well and host without bluffing.

## Tequila vs Mezcal

All tequila is technically a mezcal. Almost no mezcal is tequila.

### Tequila

One agave only: blue Weber. Made in Jalisco and four bordering states. The agave is steamed in brick ovens or autoclaves, which is why tequila reads clean, peppery, and vegetal rather than smoky.

### Mezcal

Thirty-plus agave species, centered on Oaxaca. The agave is roasted in an underground pit over hot rocks and hardwood. That pit is the entire source of the smoke - nothing is added.

### The cousins

Raicilla and bacanora are regional agave spirits under their own rules. Sotol gets shelved next to them but isn't agave at all.

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## The Age Ladder

Same spirit, different time in oak. This is the Newbie flight.

### Blanco / Plata

Unaged, or under two months. The clearest read on the agave itself. Pepper, lime, cooked vegetable.

### Reposado

"Rested" two to twelve months. Oak rounds off the pepper and brings in vanilla and caramel.

### Añejo

One to three years. Darker and rounder. This is the one whisky drinkers convert on.

### Extra Añejo

Three years and up. Dessert territory, and the point where you start paying for the barrel more than the plant.

## From Plant to Bottle

### ● Jima

A jimador strips the leaves with a coa, leaving the piña - the heart. Blue Weber needs six to eight years. Wild agaves can need twenty-five.

### ● Cooking

Steamed in ovens, or roasted in an earth pit. Starch becomes sugar here, and this single step is the biggest fork in the whole flavor road.

### ● Crushing

A roller mill, a tahona stone wheel, or a wooden mallet by hand. Tahona-crushed spirits carry noticeably more texture.

### ● Fermentation

Open-air vats, often on wild yeast that drifts in. Days, not hours.

### ● Distillation

Usually twice. Copper pot stills for tequila; traditional mezcal often runs through clay.

## READ THE LABEL

**"100% de Agave."** If the bottle doesn't say it, it's a mixto - up to 49% cane sugar. That is the source of nearly every bad tequila story anyone tells.

**NOM number.** Identifies the distillery. Two brands sharing a NOM came out of the same house.

**Additive-free.** Producers may add glycerin, vanilla, and coloring up to 1% without disclosing it. The best bottles skip it entirely.

# Pick a Tier, Buy Three Bottles

Every bottle here is widely available and additive-free or close to it.

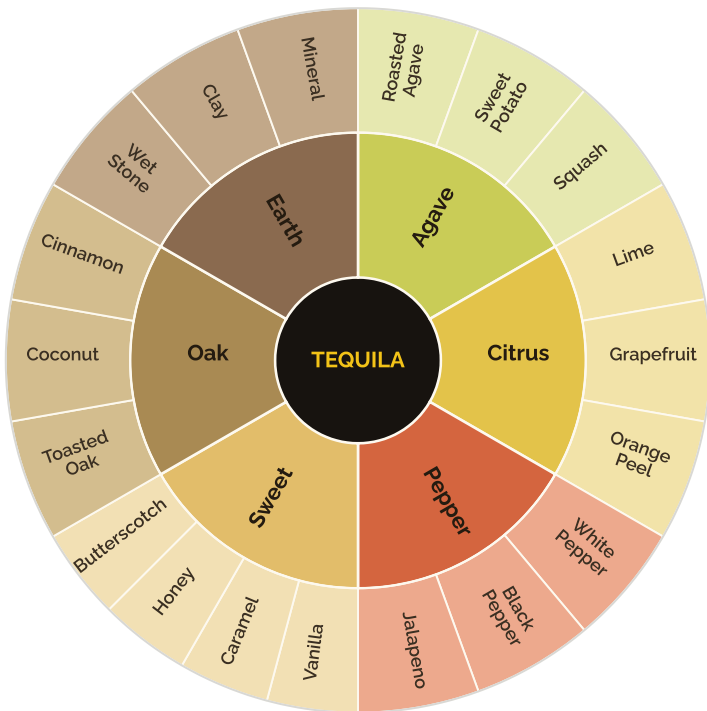
| TIER       | 🌿 TEQUILA                                                                         | 🍷 MEZCAL                                                                                  | WHAT YOU'LL TASTE                                                                                                           | PER BOTTLE                 |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Newbie     | Espolón Blanco<br>Olmea Altos Plata<br>Cimarrón Blanco<br>Milagro Silver          | Del Maguey Vida<br>Montelobos Espadín<br>400 Conejos Espadín                              | Clean cooked agave, white pepper, lime zest. The mezcal picks add a gentle campfire edge without overwhelming anyone.       | \$25–35<br>~\$9 / person   |
| Casual     | Fortaleza Blanco<br>Tapatio Blanco<br>Siete Leguas Blanco<br>G4 Blanco            | Banhez Espadín<br>Del Maguey Chichicapa<br>Bozal Ensemble<br>Real de Xalisco              | Tahona texture, olive brine, deeper roast, real minerality. This is where people stop thinking of tequila as a shot.        | \$45–70<br>~\$18 / person  |
| Aficionado | Tequila Ocho Plata<br>Fortaleza Añejo<br>El Tesoro Añejo<br>Siete Leguas D'Antano | Del Maguey Tobalá<br>Rey Campero Tepeztate<br>Mezcal Vago Elote<br>El Jolgorio Madrecuixe | Single-varietal wild agave. Tropical fruit, hard minerality, florals. Plants that grew twenty years before anyone cut them. | \$90–160<br>~\$38 / person |

**Bottle math.** A 750ml bottle pours roughly 25 one-ounce tastes. Three pours each for six guests is 18 ounces total, so **one bottle per spirit covers the night with room left over.** Buy one tier across three bottles - not one bottle from each tier.

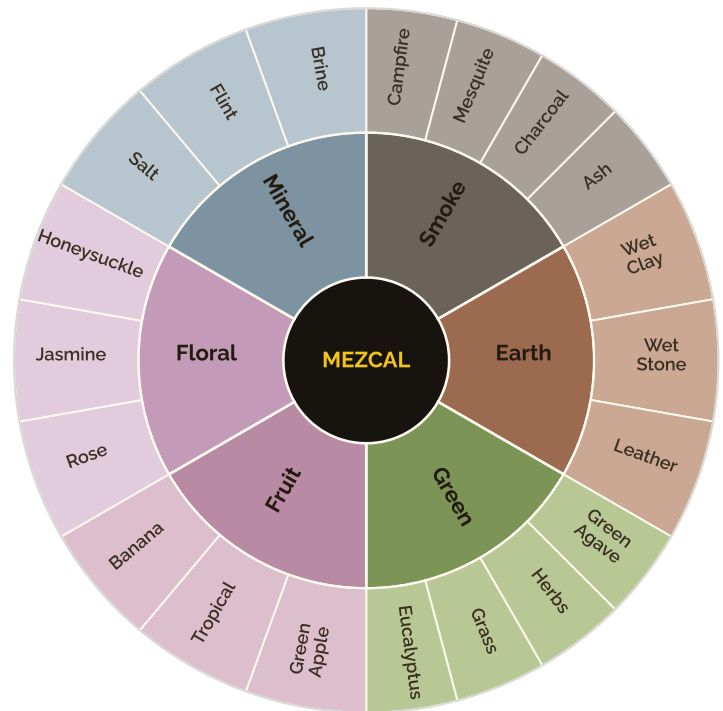
**Shopping shortcut.** If a bottle doesn't say "100% de Agave" on the front, put it back. That one rule filters out most of what goes wrong at this price range.

# Put a Word to It

Start at the center tier, work outward for something more specific.



**Tequila**



**Mezcal**

**Using the wheels:** taste first, then find the inner-ring category that fits, then work outward to the specific note. The two wheels barely overlap on purpose - that gap is exactly what the fire pit does to the same plant.

Newbie

# The Age Ladder

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THREE TEQUILAS · SAME DISTILLERY IF YOU CAN · LIGHTEST TO DARKEST

**The question:** what did the barrel actually do? Same agave, same distillery, three different amounts of oak. Everything you taste that changes is the wood.



TASTER

DATE

POUR 1

Nose · palate · finish

**Blanco**



What I poured \_\_\_\_\_

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POUR 2

Nose · palate · finish

**Reposado**



What I poured \_\_\_\_\_

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POUR 3

Nose · palate · finish

**Añejo**



What I poured \_\_\_\_\_

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BEST OF THE NIGHT

WOULD BUY AGAIN

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Casual

# Tequila Meets Mezcal

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TWO TEQUILAS AND ONE MEZCAL · THE SMOKE REVEAL SITS IN THE MIDDLE

**The question:** where does the smoke actually come from? Pour 2 is the same plant family as Pour 1, cooked in a fire pit instead of a steam oven. That is the only real difference.



TASTER

DATE

POUR 1

Nose · palate · finish

**Tequila Blanco**



What I poured \_\_\_\_\_

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POUR 2

Nose · palate · finish

**Mezcal Espadín**



What I poured \_\_\_\_\_

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POUR 3

Nose · palate · finish

**Tequila Reposado**



What I poured \_\_\_\_\_

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BEST OF THE NIGHT

WOULD BUY AGAIN

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Aficionado

## Agave Terroir

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THREE MEZCALs · THREE DIFFERENT AGAVE SPECIES · SAME PRODUCER IF POSSIBLE

**The question:** forget the process, taste the plant. Hold the producer and method steady and the only variable left is which agave went in the pit, and how long it grew.



TASTER

DATE

POUR 1

The baseline

**Espadín**



What I poured \_\_\_\_\_

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POUR 2

Wild · 12-15 yrs

**Tobalá or Cuishe**



What I poured \_\_\_\_\_

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POUR 3

Wild · 20-25 yrs

**Tepezate or Arroqueño**



What I poured \_\_\_\_\_

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BEST OF THE NIGHT

WOULD BUY AGAIN

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Everything on the list, then close the night with a real ballot.

- ☐ **Three bottles** from one tier - your Agavebase pick (pg 3)
- ☐ Copitas, veladoras, or small wine glasses - never shot glasses
- ☐ Water pitcher and plain crackers
- ☐ Orange slices, plus chili salt or sal de gusano
- ☐ Dark chocolate, salted nuts, aged cheese, grilled pineapple
- ☐ A bag or cloth to hide bottles for a blind round
- ☐ Pen at every seat for the Tasting Cards
- ☐ Small lidded jars for take-home pours (see below)

**Right glass for the table.** Copitas or small tulip-shaped wine glasses concentrate the aroma properly; a rocks glass or shot glass flattens it and tempts people into shooting instead of sipping. Skip anything wider than a wine glass.

Pass around at the end of the night. Whichever pour gets the most votes is next month's starting point.

[illegible]